

Require approval for every Claude Code write

You are an Owner of your company's Claude organization — the account under which the team uses Claude Code. In this article you make every teammate's Claude Code ask for approval before every write. Two switches and one settings text in the Claude admin console do it: **Disable Bypass permissions mode** on, **Code in the web** off, and a **Managed settings** text that starts every session in Manual, removes Auto, and makes the file tools ask even in Accept edits. Then you check it on one computer. Once, in your browser — nothing to install; people who join later are covered automatically.

FOR	Stage 1 · Owner of your Claude organization	TIME	about 20 minutes, once
VERSION	v4.7 · September 2026 · built 2026-09-04	ALSO ONLINE	Work OS Team Setup site > Setup > Require approval for every Claude Code write. Italic names are other articles of that site.

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WHY THIS MATTERS

Without the policy, Claude Code on the Team plan starts new sessions in **Auto**, where a background check approves actions instead of the person. With it, a person approves every change on every computer; the repository rule from *Set up the repository* adds a Work OS admin's approval on top for the gated files.

Before you start

- ☐ Your company uses Claude on the **Team** or **Enterprise** plan.

☐ You are an **Owner** or **Primary Owner** of the Claude organization — Admins and members can't edit these settings.

☐ Everyone on the team signs in to Claude Code with a seat in this organization (the work account from *Set up your computer*). The policy travels with that sign-in.

Step 1 — Open the Claude Code page of the admin console

- 1 Sign in at claude.ai with your Owner account.
- 2 Open **Admin settings** from the menu under your name and select **Claude Code** — or go straight to claude.ai/admin-settings/claude-code.

EXPECTED

The page shows the organization switches — **Code in the desktop**, **Code in the web**, **Remote Control**, **Disable Bypass permissions mode** (names may differ slightly) — and a **Managed settings** section. If you land on another admin page instead, your account isn't an Owner.

Step 2 — Set the organization switches

- 1 **Code in the desktop** — **on**. The Work OS runs in the Claude Code desktop app.
- 2 **Disable Bypass permissions mode** — **on**. Nobody can switch Claude Code to the mode that never asks.
- 3 **Code in the web** — **off**. Web sessions run on Anthropic's computers and approve file edits as a whole afterwards, not one by one — the opposite of this policy. The desktop app is not affected. Leave the switch on only if the team wants long tasks to run while laptops are closed and accepts that trade-off.
- 4 **Remote Control** — leave **off**, the default. It lets a person steer their own computer's session from a phone or browser, with the same approval cards, so it can be turned on later if someone asks.

Step 3 — Add the file-change policy

Step 2 removed Bypass permissions. The text below removes Auto, starts every session in Manual, and makes every write ask even in Accept edits.

- 1 Under **Managed settings**, open the settings box — the text field that takes JSON.

- 2 Paste the policy below. If the box already holds settings from your IT, add the two parts — `permissions` and `allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly` — inside the existing outer braces instead.

MANAGED SETTINGS — THE FILE-CHANGE POLICY

```
{
  "permissions": {
    "defaultMode": "default",
    "disableAutoMode": "disable",
    "disableBypassPermissionsMode": "disable",
    "ask": [
      "Edit",
      "Write",
      "NotebookEdit",
      "Bash(touch *)",
      "Bash(mkdir *)",
      "Bash(mv *)",
      "Bash(cp *)",
      "Bash(rm *)",
      "Bash(rmdir *)",
      "Bash(sed *)"
    ]
  },
  "allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly": true
}
```

- 3 Select **Save**.

EXPECTED

The console shows the saved settings without an error. Each teammate's Claude Code picks the policy up when it next starts, or within an hour if already open — nothing for them to do.

What each line does

Line	What it does
<code>"defaultMode": "default"</code>	Every session starts in Manual — Claude asks before each file change and each command.
<code>"disableAutoMode": "disable"</code>	Removes Auto from everyone's mode selector.
<code>"disableBypassPermissionsMode": "disable"</code>	Removes Bypass permissions everywhere Claude Code runs — the same as the switch in step 2.
<code>"ask": [...]</code>	Every write asks: Claude's file tools (<code>Edit</code> , <code>Write</code> , <code>NotebookEdit</code>) and the commands that create, move, copy, delete or rewrite files and folders — even if a person switches a session to Accept edits , the one mode that can't be removed.
<code>"allowManagedPermissionRulesOnly": true</code>	Nobody can weaken the policy from their own settings, and the approval card no longer offers <i>don't ask again</i> .

DON'T

Add `allow` rules for file tools or commands here — they would switch the approval off for everyone at once.

Step 4 — Check the policy on one computer

On any teammate's computer — or your own — in the Claude Code desktop app:

- 1 Quit and reopen the app, sign in with the organization account, and start a session in the Work OS folder.

EXPECTED

The mode selector next to the send button shows **Manual** and offers only Manual, Accept edits and Plan — no Auto, no Bypass permissions.

- 2 Ask for a harmless change and accept it when the approval card appears:

SAY TO CLAUDE

“Create a short test note at product-development/product/meetings/other/summaries/<today's date>-policy-test.md and mark it clearly as TEST”

EXPECTED

Before anything is written, a card shows the file and its content, and Claude waits for your yes.

- 3 Switch the mode selector to **Accept edits** and ask for another change:

SAY TO CLAUDE

“Add one more line to that test note”

EXPECTED

The approval card appears again — without the `ask` part of the policy it wouldn't. Switch back to **Manual**.

- 4 Ask Claude to change a gated file, and reject it:

SAY TO CLAUDE

“In business-info.md, correct or fill in one line”

EXPECTED

The card carries the Work OS's  **GATED FILE** note. After a reject, nothing is written.

- 5 Ask Claude to delete the test note.

YOU'RE DONE WHEN

Claude Code starts in Manual, offers neither Auto nor Bypass permissions, and shows an approval card before every file change — even in Accept edits. Tell the Work OS admin the policy is in place; people who join later need nothing. Stage 2 continues with [Set up your computer](#).

Good to know

- **Changing the policy later:** open the same page, edit the settings text, save — every Claude Code follows it at its next start or within the hour. Removing a line loosens the policy for everyone, so agree changes with the Work OS admin first.
- **Who the policy reaches:** the Code tab of the Claude desktop app, signed in with the organization account. Sign-ins with an API key or through a company gateway, and Cowork sessions, don't receive it — a device policy does (next point).
- **It is a setting, not a lock.** Anthropic describes console-managed settings as a client-side control, not a security boundary. That is why gated files also need an approved pull request on `main` ([Set up the repository](#), step 4), whatever happens on a computer.
- **Devices managed by IT** (Jamf, Intune, Group Policy) can receive the same policy text as a device policy instead: it applies to every session on that computer, Cowork and API-key sign-ins included, and can't be edited without administrator rights — but it doesn't reach sessions on Anthropic's computers. Paths and formats: Anthropic's [Deploy managed settings](#).

SoftServe · Work OS Team Setup · v4.7 · September 2026 · Built from the single source `Documentation/src/content.js` — change it there and rebuild; this file is an output.